Customer Complaints Procedure

Why complaints matter

A complaint is a chance to fix a problem and to keep a customer. Every complaint is logged, acknowledged within one working day and investigated fairly.

Handling a complaint

The first person to receive a complaint records the details in the case system, apologises where appropriate and tells the customer what happens next. Simple problems should be resolved on the spot wherever the staff member has the authority to do so.

Escalation

Complaints that cannot be resolved by the first responder follow the Willow Bridge escalation ladder: team leader within two days, service manager within five days, and the customer experience director within ten days. Each step must be documented so the customer never has to repeat their story.

Closing the loop

When a complaint is resolved the customer is contacted to confirm they are satisfied. Themes from complaints are reviewed each quarter and reported to the executive committee.

Additional guidance

The owner of customer complaints procedure reviews it at least once a year and records any change, together with the date and the reason for the change. Exceptions to customer complaints procedure require written approval and are kept on file so that they can be checked during an audit. Staff are expected to follow the arrangements for customer complaints procedure and to ask their manager when they are unsure how a rule applies to their situation.

Review and ownership

Exceptions to customer complaints procedure require written approval and are kept on file so that they can be checked during an audit. New starters are introduced to customer complaints procedure during induction, and a reminder is issued whenever the arrangements change. Questions about customer complaints procedure can be raised with the relevant team through the intranet, and answers of general interest are added to the guidance.